

Τιμοκλῆς ὁ κωμωδιοποιός

Timocles on Demagogues and Rhetoric in Middle Comedy

eul_aid: hcq

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)
Dialect: *Μικταὶ διάλεκτοι* [Mixed Dialects \(frg\)](#)
Domain: *Κωμωδία* [Comedy](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Timocles was an Athenian comic poet of the Middle Comedy, active in the later 4th century BCE, circa 330–320. No biographical details survive, but he was a contemporary of Menander, Alexis, and Antiphanes. Evidence for his career derives from fragments preserved by later authors like Athenaeus and entries in ancient catalogs.

The Suda attributes 24 plays to him, but only 28 fragments and 10 titles are extant. Known titles include Drakontion, Demosatyroi, Epichairekakos, Iketides, Karikleia, Konnisalos, Orestautokleides, Polypragmon, Porphyra, and Heroes. All works survive fragmentarily through quotation.

Timocles is significant for understanding Middle Comedy's transition from political satire to domestic themes. His fragments showcase mythological parody and contemporary social commentary, referencing philosophers, politicians, and hetairai. A notable fragment from his play **Dionysiazousai** defends comedy's social utility as a consolation by depicting the misfortunes of others.

Works (4)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Δημαγωγῶν · Comic Fragments on Demagogues](#) · 172 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Κωμωδίας · Fragments on Comedy](#) · 8 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Κωμωδίας · Fragments on Comedy](#) · 5 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ῥητορικῆς καὶ Διαφθορᾶς · Fragments on Rhetoric and Corruption](#) · 169 passages